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Boston students lag on courses

More than a third may miss new requirements

By Christopher Huffaker and John Hilliard

GLOBE STAFF

More than one-third of Boston Public Schools seniors are not on track to meet a new graduation requirement for core coursework, district data show, leaving many of them at risk of not earning high school diplomas in June.

Despite five years of lead time before students were required to pass the “MassCore” curriculum, BPS faces a graduation crisis, with more than a thousand students still falling short of the needed courses, which include four years of English and math, a year of art, and more.

High-needs students and students of color are most at risk of being held back or having to attend summer school, district data shows.

It is unclear exactly how many of the students missing core classes could be prevented from graduating. Some schools and students are exempt from the MassCore requirement, such as those in vocational career programs,

CORE, Page A4

Warren sees danger in Fed nominee

Warns Warsh is a threat to bank’s independence

By Jim Puzzanghera

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Opposing a nominee to lead the Federal Reserve is familiar territory for Massachusetts Senator Elizabeth Warren.

She voted against confirming current Fed Chair Jerome Powell twice, including after President Joe Biden, her fellow Democrat, nominated him for a second four-year term. Before that 2022 vote, Warren said Powell had serious shortcomings in financial regulation oversight and branded him “a dangerous man to head up the Fed.”

But Warren told the Globe Wednesday that President Trump’s nomination of Kevin Warsh has made the threat existential.

If Warsh is confirmed, she warned, he could destroy the central bank’s independence on monetary policy, a core tenet designed to keep Fed officials from making interest rate decisions based on politics instead of economics.

And as the top Democrat on the Senate Banking Committee, which must approve Warsh’s nomination, Warren is leading the attempt to derail it — a difficult task because Republicans hold the majority.

“Through the years, many presidents, both

WARREN, Page A7

‘We’re a less informed society, even as we’re talking more about sports than we ever have.’

CHRIS STONE, former editor of Sports Illustrated and the Los Angeles Times who runs OffBall, a sports creative studio

Sports journalism takes another hit

Layoffs at Post come as coverage shifts away from costly in-depth reporting

By Aidan Ryan

GLOBE STAFF

An investigation that revealed the “broken promises” of NFL concussion settlements. A deeply reported feature on how payments to players have reshaped college sports. Scoops on the sexual miscon-

duct allegations that derailed MLB pitcher Trevor Bauer’s career.

Those are just a sample of stories that have distinguished The Washington Post’s sports section in recent years. But the Post shuttered its sports department Wednesday, part of layoffs affecting one-third of the

newsroom in the face of a steep drop in readership, executive editor Matt Murray told newsroom staff.

The sports moves are among the most drastic of the changes, which also include deep cuts to its international coverage as well as the elimination of the paper’s books section and suspension of its daily podcast. The layoffs represent the latest in the slow erosion of American sports journalism. Recent years have seen

staff and programming cuts at Sports Illustrated, the Los Angeles Times, The New York Times, ESPN, and other outlets.

As it has become harder than ever to build and maintain sustainable media businesses, sports journalism has largely shifted away from costly in-depth reporting into talk shows, gambling advice, and analysis. The demise comes as the multi-trillion

SPORTS, Page A6

OUT OF THE RED



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

People departed the citizenM Boston Back Bay hotel through a red rotating door on Massachusetts Avenue on Wednesday. The One Dalton building was seen through the door.

SUPER BOWL LX

The power of Ann Michael Maye

She’s becoming a brand, but a question is raised

By Beth Teitell

GLOBE STAFF

Drake Maye was more than halfway through his weekly press conference, gamely addressing whether his injured shoulder might affect his Super Bowl performance, blah blah blah, when reporters finally got to the good stuff: Ann Michael Maye.

“You think she’s a bigger star than you?” a reporter called out.

“My wife?” asked the man responsible for the entire region’s mood. “I think so, for sure.”

As the Patriots head to the Super Bowl, there’s the obvious question: Can they pull off an upset? But there’s a second question: Considering that even Jets fans are in a swoon, how big can the relentlessly

charming Ann Michael Maye get?

Only our branding overlords know for sure. But in the competitive and lucrative WAGs category — that’s wives and girlfriends — she’s the season’s hottest breakout star.

What makes it even more fun: She’s not a WAG who arrived fully manicured, managed, and monetized — a Gisele, Cardi B, a Taylor Swift, if she counts — but a real person, with normal hair, who happens to be married to a man with a \$36.6 million contract, growing into the role right in front of us.

A producer of E!’s juicy reality show “WAGS Miami” says she’s meeting the moment, even if a sports studies professor sees a darker side to the WAG-In-

MAYE, Page A10

President Trump said Wednesday that he ordered the withdrawal of 700 law enforcement officers involved in the federal immigration crackdown in Minnesota and that his administration could use a “softer touch.” **A2.**

Armed extremists killed at least 162 people during attacks on two villages in western Nigeria. **A3.**

Congress passed legislation that bolsters funding for the National Institutes of Health while preventing the administration from cutting billions of dollars in support for research overhead. **B1.**



Glare-y nice

Thursday: Mostly sunny. High: 31-36. Low: 13-18.

Friday: Cloudy and cold. High: 24-29. Low: 19-24.

Sunrise: 6:53 Sunset: 5:03 Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C8-9.**

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Cross-country skiers face a new — artificial — normal

At Weston track, natural snow is increasingly rare as the climate changes

By Kate Selig

GLOBE STAFF

Cross-country skiing conjures images of graceful strides through frosted woods, surrounded by pillowy layers of soft snow that will cushion the fall of the most ungainly novice. But with increasingly unpredictable winter weather from climate change forcing more ski tracks to rely on human-made snow, even the gentlest course can rapidly turn into a terrifying and unforgiving surface.

“It’s an ice rink over there,” said Gibson Kennedy,



JOSH REYNOLDS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Jim Stock (second from left), head coach of Eastern Massachusetts Cross-Country Skiing, at the Weston track.

11, as he watched skiers carefully negotiate a slick of human-made snow in mid-January, before the big snowstorm, at the Leo J. Martin Ski Track in Weston. With a heaviness that belied his age, he added, “In 20 years, what’s it gonna be like?”

That’s the almost existential question facing cross-country skiers as climate change steadily winnows the cold weather and the snow it sustains. The recent storm brought the most snow in four years but doesn’t change the big-picture trend: The number of days with snow on

the ground is sharply declining in New England, which is warming faster than just about anywhere else on Earth. Since the early 2000s, Massachusetts has lost about 30 days of snow cover annually.

At the Weston track, which over the years has produced champions and inspired life-long passions for the sport, skiing atop manufactured snow is increasingly the norm.

Human-made snow is more akin to a tiny ice pellet than a six-sided snowflake.

SKIING, Page A6